ACADEMIC STUDIES Program Chair: Marie Shurkus

ART HISTORY

AH 102 Art History Survey II

The second semester of the art history survey course combines a chronological overview of art works from the seventeenth century through up to 1960 with a rigorous investigation of the contexts in which art has been made. The course covers major art historical developments in the western and non-western worlds with an evaluation of their form, content, style, cultural meaning, and historical import. The course also introduces students to art historical vocabulary and various methods of art historical research. Each section meets twice a week for lecture and student discussion.

Required: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. No prerequisite.

AH 250 Critical Approaches to Contemporary Art

This class provides a foundation in critical theory and in critical thinking and writing skills. We will consider the relationship between the theory and practice of art. Each week we will look at a different critical issue related to making and interpreting art, covering- the sometimes overlapping- issues of form, process, representation, reproduction, originality, distribution, institutions, gender, identity, culture and politics. We will frame these issues in relation to specific case studies drawn from a range of media, including examples from studio areas at MECA&D. Students will be encouraged to make links between critical issues covered in class and their own work, and to understand the ways that theory connects to artistic practice.

Required: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/ week. Prerequisite: AH 102 or the equivalent.

AH 312 Artist, Museums & the Art Market

This course surveys the vibrant world of global contemporary art-presentation, distribution and making. Combining lectures, guest speakers, and regular field trips to museums, galleries, artists' studios and private collections in Portland, Maine and New England, this course will present students with an overview of recent developments and important directions in new art and the institutions and individuals that collect and present it. In weekly readings about and discussions of the practices, possibilities and politics of the art world, a recurring theme will be critical thinking and career strategies for professional artists. Students will be required to read interpretive texts and to write several short "Impression Paper" essays on course subjects as well as develop a major presentation on a course theme of their choosing. Active participation in classroom discussions and meetings with guest speakers is required and a factor in grading. Please note that due to the field trip-intensive nature of this course and the logistics of scheduling meetings with curators, artists, and others, the class schedule is subject to change.

Elective: 3 credits/semester, 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: AH 250 or the equivalent.

AH 392 (S) Livable Worlds

Whether under political occupation, psychic pressure, or environmental duress artists, writers and filmmakers have found ways to live in what are otherwise unlivable conditions. In this class, we will focus on fantasy-worlds in dreams and drawings; imaginations of political community through deep listening and sonic haunting; the intersection of resistance with gendered experience; and how environmental art has occupied public space in liberatory ways. How can surrealist topographical maps, site-specific sculpture, or spirals of earth help us to imagine or organize livable worlds?

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: AH 250 or the equivalent.

AH 397 19th-Century Media Worlds

This course explores some of the nineteenth-century media that shaped the art and visual culture of global modernity and, in numerous cases, that of other disciplinary spheres. Whether newly invented, 'revived,' or of longer standing, media including wood engravings, electrotypes, daguerreotypes, plaster casts, chromolithographs, woodblock prints, glass, and embroidery participated in local and global circuits of exchange, changing how people looked at and understood the world and themselves. Students will learn about diverse mediums' material dimensions, movements, and legacies, as well as their adopters' and users' negotiations of invention and tradition.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: AH 250 or the equivalent.

ACADEMIC STUDIES *[continued]*

ENGLISH COMPOSITION

EN 100 English Composition

Reading and writing are essential parts of college learning and successful art & design practice. In this class, students will explore a variety of approaches to reading and writing, including close reading and textual analysis, critical and comparative analysis, and reflective, argumentative writing. Students will be introduced to three major genres of text: the novel; the graphic novel; and poetry.

Required: 3 credits/semester, 3 hours/week. No prerequisite.

HUMANITIES

HU 361 (S) Ruins & Reclamation

According to many environmental thinkers, we currently live among the ruins of an already-present environmental catastrophe. This not only means that processes currently set in motion will result in irreversible and irrevocable climatic harm to-come, but that depending from what perspective you look the contemporary appears in ruin. We will investigate how theorists and artists have understood the figure of the ruin as holding together the past with the present, so as to allow for a critical reading of current conditions. From a different angle, under the threat of rising seas and ecological disruption, literatures of environmental management take an interest in potentially ruined ecosystems in order to reclaim them. We will read restoration ecology, sustainability science, and ecological resilience to investigate the discourse of when ruined ecosystems are said to be renewed, recover, or otherwise able to resist further degradation. The class will promote site-based research and engagement off-campus, as we think together how practices of reclamation may help us read processes of ruination.

Elective: 3 credits/semester, 3 hours/week. Prerequisites: EN 100 & HU 200 or the equivalent.

HU 370 (W) Writing Past Catharsis: Micro-Memoir

One doesn't have to live a long life to write a memoir; a memoir is not an autobiography. It is a snapshot from your life, a polaroid from a moment where everything changed. In this class, you will learn how to take experiences from your life--from wild and poignant experiences to ordinary and typical--and learn how to create a short memoir and/or collection of essays that is a work of well-crafted art. Because word after word after word equals power.

Elective: 3 credits/semester, 3 hours/week. Prerequisites: EN 100 & HU 200 or the equivalent.

HU 380 Zombie Poiesis: Beyond Capitalism

In “Theses on a Philosophy of History,” Walter Benjamin emphasizes the importance of “the ancestors” to the struggle against fascism. This course will examine the figure of the zombie as a generative ally in navigating the end of a colonial capitalist modernity built on racial violence. Grounding ourselves in a critical history of the zombie as an aspect of nineteenth-century Afro-Caribbean religious liberation practices, we will explore approaches contemporary thinkers and makers have taken in incorporating the dead as living part of their practices. We will also consider the role of the dead in our own practices.

Elective: 3 credits/semester, 3 hours/week. Prerequisites: EN 100 & HU 200 or the equivalent.

HU 381 (S) Witchcraft

Whether through speech, behavior, or social critique women have long shown opposition, both spiritual and political, to dominant forms of cultural life. In order to do so, the class turns to the figure of the “witch,” a figure who carries anxiety and fear about feminine forms of community and power.

We look at that figure in popular culture, such as in the Wicked franchise, but also in historical texts that concern visions. At turns evil and unnatural, unruly and disorderly, but yet associated with the earth and with the feminine, we also consider how the “witch” has been an important figure in eco-feminism.

ACADEMIC STUDIES *[continued]*

The class attends to the production of fear and evil by looking at historical witch trials in New England; considers notions of insanity and female hysteria; as well as "mad" speech, such as that seen in witness or personal testimony. Finally, as we attempt to think outside of masculine logics of belief and reality, the class focuses on spells, curses and black magic.
Elective: 3 credits/semester, 3 hours/week. Prerequisites: EN 100 & HU 200 or the equivalent.

NATURAL SCIENCE / MATH

NS 255 (AE) The Business of Art
The practical and administrative aspects of a profession and life in the Arts (visual, fiber, graphic and other) are examined in this seminar. Topics include: speaking articulately about your work, budgeting basics, marketing your work, building a sustainable fundraising program that fits your artistic practice, cultivating relationships with key industry professionals, pitching your artistry, among other topics. Guest Artists and Arts Administrators from New England will join us with informative presentations that shed light on the practicalities and realities of being a professional artist. Over the course of the semester, students will design a hands-on plan and accompanying budget focused on developing and pursuing a life in the arts post-graduation. By the end of the course, participants will be better prepared to perform the business tasks expected of arts professionals aimed at promoting your work, funding it and growing artistically within the larger arts landscape.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: EN 100 or the equivalent.

NS 304 (PE) (S) Living Sustainably
Are you concerned about what is happening to the health of our planet? Do you find yourself feeling helpless to do anything about it? Then your first step should be to take sustainable living, the class that examines how our daily lives affect the normal functioning of our biosphere. We explore water, solid waste, single-use plastic, and discuss what you can do to live more sustainably and make a real difference! This class includes field trips, guest speakers, instructions for hands-on activities such as making homemade laundry detergent, and the chance to incorporate your knowledge and interests into a work of art.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: EN 100 or the equivalent.

NS 319 (PE) (S) The Biodesign Challenge: Concepts and Practice
This course employs art, design and scientific practice as sites of creative inquiry and civic responsibility. Students explore topics such as Speculative Design, Bioethics, Green Technology and the role of Art and Design in shaping Biofutures. The course emphasizes scientific literacy, critical analysis, ethical reasoning, and the translation of complex research into accessible, imaginative and impactful frameworks. This class centers on research, dialogue, and proposal development. Students formulate a focused research question, engage with scientific literature, consider feasibility and impact, and articulate a well-supported creative response grounded in systems thinking and responsible innovation. This course incorporates group work and presentations and will include one final, creative project. Students engage with scientific research as a foundation for creative development—no science background required.

Note: *This course offers a unique opportunity to develop a biodesign project for submission to the Biodesign Challenge (BDC), an international competition culminating in presentations at the Museum of Modern Art (MoMA) in New York City. One project will be chosen to represent MECA&D at the annual BDC Summer Summit (all course grades are determined independently of this opportunity).*

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: EN 100 or the equivalent.

NS 322 (PE) (S) Citizen Science
This project-based course explores how creative practitioners participate in and contribute to scientific inquiry at the local level. Grounded in citizen science and community-engaged research, students investigate pressing ecological issues within our surrounding coastal, forested, and/or agricultural environments. Drawing on MECA&D's proximity to these areas and a network of life science experts, the course emphasizes collaboration, fieldwork, and direct ecological engagement.

ACADEMIC STUDIES *[continued]*

Students develop research-driven projects that respond to real conditions in our regional ecosystems, integrating observation, data collection, creative practice, and public communication. Through hands-on investigation the course positions art and design as active participants in environmental stewardship and community knowledge-building.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: EN 100 or the equivalent.

PHILOSOPHY / WORLD HISTORY

PL 226 Gender Theory
Although theoretical reflection on the nature and meaning of gender is perhaps as old as theory itself, recent innovations in the philosophical study of gender have changed the way we think, speak and act. At the same time, however, many of the critical concepts and theoretical frameworks mobilized by gender theorists have been sources of significant controversy both inside and outside the academy. This course introduces the philosophical study of gender, paying close attention to recent developments and debates within the field.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: EN 100 or the equivalent.

PL 228 Anti-hegemonic Thought: Literature and Philosophy
This course examines writings from across the globe. From Latin America and the Caribbean to the Middle East, Africa and Oceania, Europe and North America, we will explore the largely open concept of "Anti-hegemonic Thought" through both creative fiction and nonfiction (poetry, short stories, autobiographies, etc.) whilst also looking into theoretical texts.

During the semester, students will consider thematic and transnational contexts to explore multiple intersections of capitalism, class, gender, race, sexuality, imperialism, war, indigeneity, and settler colonialism (among other theoretical frameworks). Course texts focus on creative and critical works that imagine or create alternatives to enduring forms of capital, colonial, imperial, and racial violence.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: EN 100 or the equivalent.

WH 249 History as Narrative Storytelling
The historian C.L.R. James famously said "There is no drama like the drama of history." The writing of history is the writing of narratives - winners and losers, high stakes battles and romances, and world changing events. In this course, we will study history as narrative and the process of producing a strong and compelling story and narrative. We will read historical narratives from around the world and examine how narratives about a historical event shift and change as new storytellers take on events. We will also take a deep dive into how to craft narratives - both as historians and artists. In doing so, we will explore how the power of narrative storytelling can help change the world.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: EN 100 or the equivalent.

WH 252 Slavery, Abolition, and the coming of Civil War
Ours are most certainly fractured and fraught times. It has been said of the US that we are in the midst of a cold civil war. Too, folks ask, Has it—the country, the world, etc.—ever been this bad? Well, yes—at least as pertains to the country. In the 19th century a very hot civil war blazed for four years, killing some 700,000 souls by latest estimate, and coming very near, in 1863, to bringing the curtain down on American democracy. Now seems an instructive moment to return to the antebellum 19th century to (re)discover how and why the nation barreled toward war. Some reasons will undoubtedly feel unfamiliar. Others, however, including the seizure of Black and brown folk by federal agents, the demonizing of one's political opposition, and questions over who is and who is not a citizen, most certainly will not. History has much to tell us about our current moment, this history—the years leading to the Civil War—particularly so given the times in which we live.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: EN 100 or the equivalent.

ACADEMIC STUDIES *[continued]*

MINORS – ACADEMIC

ART HISTORY MINOR Art History Minor Coordinator: Rose Logie

The art history minor is made up of 21 credits: AH 101, AH 102, AH 250, AH 440, and 9 credits of 300 level art history electives, two of which must be writing intensive (aka marked with a W). Students applying for the Art History minor must maintain a 3.0 (B) average or higher in their art history courses. To apply for the minor students should complete an application and submit a writing sample (an art history or liberal arts paper.) Once the application and writing sample are submitted, applicants should schedule a meeting with the Art History Minor Coordinator to discuss their interests and potential faculty members who might oversee their thesis. Any substitutions to the minor requirements are subject to the Academic Studies Department Chair's approval.

AH 440 Art History Minor Thesis
Students pursuing the minor may enroll in this course either semester. Students work with a thesis advisor.
Independent Study: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisites: AH 250 and permission of Minor Program Coordinator.

(W) WRITING MINOR Writing Minor Coordinator: Pedro Daher

The writing minor is made up of 18 credits: EN 100, HU 323, HU 336, HU 440 along with 6 cr. of Writing Intensive course electives. Any MECA&D student who has successfully completed a minimum of 30 credits and has achieved a 3.0 (B) average or higher in EN 100 may apply for the writing minor. Course electives that can be applied toward the writing minor are desinated with (W) before the course title. The Writing Minor application can be obtained from the coordinator. Once the application is completed, students should schedule an interview with the Writing Minor Coordinator. Courses that can be used in this minor are designated with (W). Any substitutions to the minor requirements are subject to the Academic Studies Department Chair's approval.

HU 440 (W) Writing Minor Capstone
Writing Capstone is the capstone course of the Writing Minor. Each student will focus on an individual writing project totaling at least 100 pages: a novella; memoir; a play or series of plays; compilation of poetry; short story collection; compilation of essays/blog entries; graphic novel, etc. This individual writing project will be "workshopped" in a writing group of peer editors--fellow Writing Workshop class members--led by the professor. Multiple drafts of each project will be required in response to the group's feedback. The culmination of the course will be the publication of each student's work, either through self-publishing or traditional publishing.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: completion of 15 cr. in writing minor.

(S) SUSTAINABLE ECOSYSTEMS: ART & DESIGN (SEAD) MINOR SEAD Minor Coordinator: sabine stxrm

Sustainable Ecosystems: Art & Design (SEAD) minor is an 18 credit minor with the following requirements: FN 108 (S) Research & Inquiry, (S) AH Elective, (S) Open Elective, (S) NS Elective, (S) PL Elective, and HU 445 Sustainable Ecosystems: Art & Design Minor Capstone. Any substitutions are subject to the Academic Studies Department Chair's approval. Courses that can be used in this minor are designated with (S).

HU 445 (S) Sustainable Ecosystems: Art & Design Minor Capstone
The SEAD Capstone is designed to give students an opportunity to draw upon all of the Academic threads of the minor--art history, humanities, philosophy, and science--and develop a final research project that culminates in a studio project relevant to their SEAD studies. Each student will be expected to integrate environmental justice and ethics, sustainability, and design to produce a cohesive and practical arts-based project that addresses a local environmental issue. Through this project, students will demonstrate planning, communication, and leadership skills as well as a substantial studio effort. The projects may include a proposed design solution, an individual work or activist project made in response to a specific local climate concern or issue, etc. A statement of purpose and a project plan is required; the project concept and scope must be approved by the Coordinator of the SEAD Minor.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: completion of 15 cr. in SEAD minor.

ACADEMIC STUDIES *[continued]*

ACCELERATED ONLINE GRADUATE PROGRAM

Program Dean: Heather Holland

An accelerated master's or graduate certificate program allows students to complete graduate-level coursework in a shorter timeframe by combining undergraduate and graduate study. Eligible undergraduate students may enroll in select online graduate courses during their senior year. These courses count toward both undergraduate and graduate degree requirements.

Eligibility Requirements

Prospective students must meet the following requirements to apply to the Accelerated Online Graduate Program:

– Be a current BFA Junior.

– Have a minimum cumulative GPA of 3.2.

– Complete 90 undergraduate credits by the start of the Fall 2026 semester.

Students must apply and be accepted to the Accelerated Program before enrolling. Inquire with the Registrar's Office for more information.

Students can choose from the following programs:

Accelerated Master of Arts in Education (MAEd)

MAE 803 Contemporary Artist Survey (e-Term 3, January–March)

This course is a dynamic course designed for art educators seeking to enrich their pedagogical approach with an in-depth exploration of contemporary art. This course offers a comprehensive overview of the latest developments in global contemporary art. Participants will examine the works of influential and diverse contemporary artists, delve into their conceptual underpinnings, and unpack the socio-political contexts that shape their practices. Educators will develop strategies to integrate contemporary art into their curriculum, fostering critical thinking and creative engagement among their students. This course is ideal for art educators who wish to remain at the forefront of artistic innovation and educational excellence.

3 credits. Fulfills BFA "Any Type" Academic Elective.

MAE 804 Creative Inquiry: Introduction to Arts-Based Research (e-Term 4, March–May)

This course is designed for creative professionals across arts education and the creative industries who seek to deepen their research skills within artistic and professional contexts. It offers a broad exploration of qualitative, quantitative, and mixed-methods research designs, tailored to the unique needs of action research, creative practice, and professional development, with an emphasis on reflective action research. Participants will learn to formulate research questions, design studies, ethically collect and analyze data, and interpret findings with a critical eye toward advancing outcomes, advocating effectively, and enhancing their creative practices. The curriculum also incorporates qualitative interviewing methods, blending theoretical knowledge with practical application to ensure students are well-prepared to conduct research and contribute valuable insights across diverse creative fields.

3 credits. Fulfills BFA "Any Type" Academic Elective.

Accelerated Graduate Certificate in Expressive Arts Therapy

AT 810 Resilient Learning Environments (e-Term 3, January–March)

This course explores student-centered and trauma-informed art education practices to meet the diverse needs of all learners. This 8-week online asynchronous course delves into creating resilient learning through art, including classrooms or other settings. Participants will engage with contemporary theories and practical strategies to support emotional and psychological well-being in educational settings.

3 credits. Fulfills BFA "Any Type" Academic Elective.

AT 812 Theoretical Foundations and Methods of Expressive Arts Therapies (e-Term 3, January–March)

This course combines a deep dive into the theoretical foundations of expressive arts therapies with hands-on methods, offering a comprehensive exploration of how creative practices can support healing and well-being. Participants will study the key theories that guide art therapy, music therapy, movement therapy, and other modalities, focusing on approaches such as psychodynamic, humanistic, and

ACADEMIC STUDIES *[continued]*

trauma-informed practices, as well as neuroaesthetics and culturally responsive methods. In addition to theoretical learning, the course integrates practical applications through hands-on activities and methodology workshops, where participants will engage in creative processes and explore the therapeutic potential of various art forms. Participants will apply theoretical knowledge to real-world case studies and creative exercises, gaining both the understanding and skills needed to implement expressive arts therapies in diverse settings.

This course is designed for therapists, educators, and professionals seeking to blend theory with practice, grounding their work in solid theoretical frameworks while acquiring practical tools to facilitate healing through the arts.
3 credits. Fulfills BFA "Any Type" Academic Elective.

AT 814 Emotional Intelligence & Artistic Learning (e-Term 4, March–May)
This course explores integrating social-emotional learning (SEL) competencies within creative practices across industries. It is designed for professionals who aim to foster holistic development through creative expression. Participants will examine the five SEL skills – self-awareness, self-management, social awareness, relationship skills, and responsible decision-making – and learn strategies for embedding these into artistic pedagogy and classroom culture. Through a blend of theory, research, and practice, the course will cover how to create art lessons that not only teach technical skills but also promote emotional intelligence, empathy, and a deeper connection with oneself and others. Educators will leave the course with a toolkit of approaches for nurturing resilient, mindful, and creatively empowered individuals.
3 credits. Fulfills BFA "Any Type" Academic Elective.

AT 816 Adaptive Art: Fostering Inclusive Creative Practices (e-Term 4, March–May)
This course is designed for professionals across creative industries—artists, educators, entrepreneurs, and organizational leaders—who aspire to foster innovation and drive positive change within their organizations and communities. It explores how creative leadership inspires new ideas, cultivates inclusive environments, and designs sustainable solutions, equipping participants with frameworks for creative problem-solving, strategic thinking, and adaptive leadership in dynamic environments. Participants will engage in research on a number of leadership theories, learn from case studies of successful art leaders, and develop strategies to effectively lead. Students will prepare to become visionary leaders who champion the visual arts, drive cultural initiatives, and influence policy to become visionary leaders capable of driving meaningful change across education, business, and community settings.
3 credits. Fulfills BFA "Any Type" Academic Elective.

Accelerated Graduate Certificate in Arts Leadership & Administration

AL 813 Introduction to Creative Leadership (e-Term 3, January–March)
This course is designed for professionals across creative industries—artists, educators, entrepreneurs, and organizational leaders—who aspire to foster innovation and drive positive change within their organizations and communities. It explores how creative leadership inspires new ideas, cultivates inclusive environments, and designs sustainable solutions, equipping participants with frameworks for creative problem-solving, strategic thinking, and adaptive leadership in dynamic environments. Participants will engage in research on a number of leadership theories, learn from case studies of successful art leaders, and develop strategies to effectively lead. Students will prepare to become visionary leaders who champion the visual arts, drive cultural initiatives, and influence policy to become visionary leaders capable of driving meaningful change across education, business, and community settings.
3 credits. Fulfills BFA "Any Type" Academic Elective.

AL 817 Financial Management and Grant Writing for Arts Organizations (e-Term 4, March–May)
This course will explore the unique skills and knowledge arts leaders need to navigate the intersection of creativity, business, and community impact. Key elements include strategic planning, audience engagement, program development, marketing, partnerships, and overcoming barriers to access. This course will include and center hands-on relevant experience from the field, including of the instructors and participants. By the end of the course, participants will have the tools to design and implement effective strategies that enhance organizational impact and foster community connections.
3 credits. Fulfills BFA "Any Type" Academic Elective.

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES

DRAWING / FOUNDATION

Program Chair: Tracey Cockrell

DR 100 Introduction to Drawing
This course introduces drawing from perception, including techniques for measurement, contour, massing, volume, and rendering illumination through value. Compositional skills such as placement and figure/ground interaction are stressed. Drawing materials include vine charcoal, compressed charcoal, stamp, and india ink; subject matter includes still life, interior, landscape, and the figure.
Required: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

DR 110 Honors: Introduction to Drawing
The Honors section of Introduction to Drawing is a rigorous and demanding course designed for the advanced student. This course introduces drawing from perception, including techniques for measurement, contour, massing, volume, and rendering illumination through value. Compositional skills such as placement and figure/ground interaction are stressed. Drawing materials include vine charcoal, compressed charcoal, stamp, and India ink; subject matter includes still life, interior, landscape, and the figure.
Required: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

DR 227 Anatomical Drawing
This class is an in-depth study of the internal structure of the human figure as it affects the external form, allowing students to develop a working vocabulary of surface muscle groups and skeletal landmarks as they apply to drawing the figure. Students complete weekly research projects designed to compliment classroom topics. Class time is used primarily for study from the live model and critique. Application of knowledge gained throughout the course to individual aesthetic and conceptual concerns is encouraged.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: DR 100 or DR 110.

DR 140 Thinking with Drawing
This course focuses on using drawing to get to a core idea. Drawing can be used as a process of reflection, discovery, proposal, and presentation; a tool for thinking. While drawings themselves may not be the endgame of artists' and designers' research and creativity, the practice can be the starting point and conversation support for an idea and an integral part of the ideation process. Think storyboard, object or project proposal, working drawing, layout, thumbnail, and whatever else bridges the gap between the artist's imagination and the need for the maker to work through a concept. A drawing can be used to propose things that aren't quite visible or don't yet exist. Through the invitation of visiting faculty, students are exposed to a wide range of studio practices that use drawing (e.g., furniture making, metal fabrication, ceramics, illustration and design concepts, set design, architecture, digital media, film, etc.). Projects include prompted exercises that lead up to summative personal independent work.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: DR 100 / DR 110 or instructor permission.

FN 109 3D: Materiality
This course investigates three-dimensional phenomena and cultivates an understanding of design and composition in three dimensions. This course equips students with the ability to create and discuss three-dimensional work with intention and precision. Through the choice of paired 7-week mini courses, students will gain an applied understanding of the principles and elements of Three-Dimensional Design while acquiring an understanding of specific materials and fabrication techniques. Choice of paired study from the following departments: Ceramics, Metals, Sculpture, Textiles, or Woodworking. The course works in conjunction with all Foundation studio, Liberal Arts and Art History courses.
Required: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

FN 110 4D: Space & Temporality
This course investigates modes of practice beyond the creation of objects. Space and Temporality focuses on verbs; process as opposed to product. Space & Temporality cultivates an understanding of design and composition within time and space. The class explores these principles through developing an understanding of the body as a dynamic object in time and space, lens-based seeing, light,

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

audio, sequential and process-based drawing, and the moving image. Processes and materials include both conventional and digital approaches. The course blends multiple working methodologies, strategies and tools to emphasize the specific learning objectives. The course works in conjunction with all Foundation studio, Liberal Arts and Art History courses.

Required: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

ART EDUCATION

Program Chair: Rachel Somerville

4 + 1 BFA / Art Education Accelerated MAT

Maine College of Art & Design's 4+1 BFA/Art Education Accelerated MAT provides a streamlined pathway for students to earn their Bachelor of Fine Arts in four years and their Master of Arts in Teaching in one year, qualifying students to be certified to teach Visual Art in K-12 public schools in five years with no lapse in matriculation status. Students can indicate interest anytime between enrollment and third year in the BFA program. Must show consistent, satisfactory academic performance to qualify for the pathway.

Inquire with the Registrar's Office for more information.

AE 329 Contemporary Practices for Art Teaching

This course introduces undergraduates to the core principles and frameworks for teaching and learning art techniques. Students will develop an understanding of current instructional practices and gain confidence teaching children through guided practice. Rooted in both theory and practice, this hybrid philosophy and studio course teaches students to apply the dynamics of group inquiry while also making art. Direct experimentation with pedagogy, materials, and art-making are key components in this course. Students will plan and implement meaningful learning activities with community partners, such as museums, schools, or community centers.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisites: EN 100 and at least one 100 level Studio Elective.

ANIMATION & GAME ART

Program Chair: Adam Fisher

AG 100 Intro to Game Development

This course will introduce students to the foundational aspects of game development. Starting with elemental lessons that teach students the basics of working in game engines and give insights about the game industry on a whole, we'll move into design- or theory-based projects about game mechanics and art production. Game development is a complex, multidisciplinary practice, and this course will serve as the bedrock for the rest of your gamedev journey here at MECA&D.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

AG 101 Animation I

This course introduces and explores the twelve principles of animation as developed at the Disney Animation Studios. Assigned projects guide students through the technical and creative processes involved in 2D digital animation. Students apply the principles to create sequential drawings that give personality and emotion to moving objects and simple characters.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

AG 120 Storyboarding for Animation

In animation, storytelling is about much more than writing a script. This course will explore the full story development pipeline from loglines and storybeats to finished animatic. We will cover the basics of narrative structure, cinematic grammar, and story-based character development with a specific focus on developing narrative or experimental work for animation.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

AG 199 Character Design for Games & Animation

Great characters don't happen by accident—they are the result of deliberate, thoughtful design. In this course, we will analyze iconic characters from games and animation, breaking down what makes them memorable and effective. Through a progressive, iterative process, students will develop their own characters with a focus on visual impact, audience relevance, and personality-driven design. We will emphasize structured iteration, exploring how shape, proportion, silhouette, and detail work together to strengthen a character's identity. Additionally, students will refine their designs through backstory development, prop exploration, and stylization. By the end of the course, students will have fully realized character concepts ready for entertainment design.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

AG 221 Sophomore Production Lab

Students in Sophomore Production Lab will use the knowledge and skills they have picked up over their first three semesters to create a short original animated film or game project. They will work individually or collaboratively to execute their creative vision while learning to budget their time as they navigate their way through a full production pipeline.

Major requirement: 3 cr./semester; 6 Hrs/week. Prerequisites: Sophomore AG Major standing and successful completion of AG 100 or AG 101.

AG 245 Intro to 3D Modeling & Animation

Great characters don't happen by accident—they are the result of deliberate, thoughtful design. In this course, we will analyze iconic characters from games and animation, breaking down what makes them memorable and effective. Through a progressive, iterative process, students will develop their own characters with a focus on visual impact, audience relevance, and personality-driven design. We will emphasize structured iteration, exploring how shape, proportion, silhouette, and detail work together to strengthen a character's identity. Additionally, students will refine their designs through backstory development, prop exploration, and stylization. By the end of the course, students will have fully realized character concepts ready for entertainment design.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

AG 322 Major Production Studio II

Students continue explorations begun in AG 321 or start new experiments in animation or game art. Faculty will determine the depth and number of projects appropriate for students on an individual basis. Mandatory group critiques serve as anchor points in project scheduling. All projects will result in finished work for inclusion in a portfolio to be developed in SEM 451 Professional Studio.

Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisites: Junior standing & successful completion of AG 321 Major Production Studio I.

AG 323 Special Topics: Post Production & VFX for Animation

Every animation and film production follows a production pipeline that ends in post. This course will cover the processes and tools of post-production. With an emphasis on compositing, visual effects, motion tracking, keying, transitions, track mattes, motion graphics and more. Students will gain an understanding of the technical pipeline for digital assets and use of the tools of Post production to polish and finish their work. They will work to combine various media and styles of work from Stop motion to 2D/3D animation and live action elements. Students are welcome to bring assets from their current projects to work with in class.

Elective: 3 credits/semester, 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: FN 110.

AG 324 Special Topics: Storyboarding II

This course will cover more advanced topics in storyboarding, such as shot selection, framing, pacing, camera movement and editing animatics. Weekly assignments will emphasize refining their boards based on regular reviews and peer feedback. The goal will be to simulate a studio environment where addressing notes and hitting deadlines are expected.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: AG 120 Storyboarding for Animation.

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

AG 345 Intermediate 3D Modeling & Animation
A fast-paced survey course for students who love digital 3d, this class builds upon the foundation of Intro to 3d Modeling and Animation. Through demos, walk-throughs, and projects, students will explore topics such as high poly modeling, digital sculpting, PBR material generation, advanced rigging, and character animation.
Elective: 3 credits/semester, 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: AG 245.

AG 351 Animation & Game Art Concepts and History
This course offers a historical and critical overview of animation and game art. Case studies in animation and game art will be presented and discussed. Assigned readings, playings, and viewings will introduce and illustrate the formal, conceptual, and kinetic norms of animation and narrative across media platforms. Students will create written and/or visual responses to each of the major themes of the course.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: Major Standing.

AG 352 Collaborative Productions
Teams of students work with faculty mentors to create and produce short animations or games. Emphasis is placed on individual engagement, creative vision, open communication, and setting goals. Projects will move from the writer's table, through pre-production to production, and on to post-production. All team members will contribute ideas, support, and labor in each step of the process. Alliances and teams may choose to work collaboratively in other Animation and Game Art courses.
Major requirement: 3 credits/ semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: Junior Major standing.

AG 422 Major Capstone Production
Using the project started in AG 421 Major Capstone Project Pre-Production, students create a final animation, game, or collection of visual development assets to be presented in the BFA Thesis Show. Additionally, students will give a public lecture on their Capstone Production and supply appropriate documentation of the project for the online BFA Thesis Show. All work will be included in the portfolio developed in SEM 451 Professional Studio.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. 6 credit option. Prerequisites: Senior standing & successful completion of AG 421.

AG 452 Major Capstone Project Post-Production
This course is an extension of AG 422 in which students produce a significant Thesis or Capstone project. Examples of these projects include: Short films, Animations, 2D and 3D Games or Game Art, Interactive Media Installations, Collections of Concept Art with animatics and/or promotional trailers. Time in this course is devoted to project production and post-production including the production of written and visual promotional materials. Students may choose to write an optional research paper on their final project if they feel that research and writing supports and extends their studio practice.
Major requirement: 6 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: AG 421.

ART & MUSIC

Program Chair: Steve Drown

AM 104 Instrumental Lab: Choral Ensemble
If you like singing in a group or want to learn, this class is for you. Students will learn to sing in a group setting and as a featured soloist. Contemporary and traditional vocal music will be performed. No previous experience needed for this 7-week course.
Elective: 1 credit/semester; 1.5 hours/week. No prerequisite. Course meets for the first 7 weeks of the semester.

AM 105 Instrument Lab: Keyboard
This course is designed for beginning to intermediate keyboardists. The class is a 7-week group lesson for developing your piano skills and understanding standard music notation. Students will use 88-note, piano-style keyboards during class time and have access to

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

our practice rooms with the same equipment.
Elective: 1 credit/semester; 1.5 hours/week. No prerequisite. Course meets for the first 7 weeks of the semester.

AM 110 (M) Intro to Digital Audio Recording
Students will learn digital audio production and music production using contemporary recording techniques and Digital Audio Workstation applications in MECA&D's recording studio. The simple physics of sound will be demystified. Basic recording skills, including the use of microphones, outboard and plug-in audio processing and mixing will be emphasized. Project-based, hands-on exercises throughout the course will reinforce the concepts covered.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

AM 220 Songwriting
This course will focus on individual creativity as well as collaboration. Students will be given writing assignments and explore in-class brainstorming sessions. This includes writing as a band/group and establishing musical partnerships that divide responsibilities, e.g. lyrics and music. The class will include creation and performance of music. Basic music theory concepts will be introduced to support and enhance the creative process.
Elective: 3 credits/semester, 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

CERAMICS

Program Chair: Patrick Coughlin

CE 245 (PE) Empty Bowls & Community Engagement
This course offers students a practical and experiential learning experience in community engagement by focusing on organizing and executing an "Empty Bowls" fundraiser. One of the critical aspects of the course involves creating ceramic bowls. Students will learn the art of vessel making and ceramics, exploring different techniques to shape and mold clay into beautiful and functional bowls. This hands-on experience will not only develop their artistic abilities but also instill a sense of craftsmanship and creativity.

Students will also be involved in sourcing food from local commercial kitchens. They will learn about the importance of food safety, quality, and sustainability while establishing connections with local businesses. This process will provide insights into the logistics of acquiring food resources for the fundraiser and the significance of supporting local communities. The course emphasizes the establishment of partnerships with organizations that combat food insecurity. Students will learn about the challenges faced by individuals and communities affected by food insecurity and explore ways to collaborate with relevant organizations. This aspect of the course fosters a deeper understanding of the social issues surrounding food security and the importance of community support.

Marketing plays a crucial role in the success of any fundraising event, and this course recognizes that. Students will learn about effective marketing strategies and techniques to promote the "Empty Bowls" fundraiser. They will gain practical experience in creating promotional materials, utilizing social media platforms, and engaging with the community to raise awareness and generate interest in the event.

The culmination of the course is a ticketed event where the bowls created by the students will be showcased and sold to raise funds for local food security initiatives.Students will actively participate in organizing and managing this event, gaining valuable event planning and coordination skills. This hands-on experience will provide a real-world understanding of the efforts required to execute a successful fundraising event.

Overall, this course offers students a comprehensive and immersive learning experience in community engagement. By actively participating in the various stages of the "Empty Bowls" fundraiser, students will develop practical skills, gain a deeper understanding of food security issues, and positively impact their local community."
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

CE 250 Slip Casting and Press Molding

This course emphasizes developing skills and technical knowledge in ceramic mold-making processes. Clay is a very flexible material; it can be shaped and formed by numerous methods and techniques. In this course, students will explore the unique properties of liquid casting slip and plaster mold-making. Topics include plaster molds for ceramic slip casting, block molds, two-part, and complex molds. Lecture and research topics encompass mold-making and casting in art and industry, historical applications, and contemporary materials/processes. Students will learn to create clay prototypes for simple one-piece molds and learn about more complex multi-piece plaster molds taken from other prototypes. The concept of "multiplicity" will be explored by using the molds to produce multiple objects and then proceed to creating complex assembled forms composed of many slip-cast parts. This course will introduce a range of functional and sculptural forms.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

CE 302 Ceramics III: Major Studio

This course is the primary studio component for the spring semester of the junior year in the ceramics major. The course builds upon the experiences of CE 301, and it continues to foster the development of a personal sense of direction. Through a structure of self-directed assignments, Juniors learn to take responsibility for self-directed work individually. During the semester, students increase their vocabulary of skills and concepts. Students also continue to relate their work to historical and contemporary issues. Additionally, students gain more experience in operating various kilns and explore various clay bodies appropriate for their work. A combination of group discussions, demonstrations, shared and individual crits, and one-on-one dialogue further augment the growth and maturation of personally driven studio work.

Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: CE 301.

CE 305 Ceramics Throwing – Advanced

In this ceramics course, the student will build upon throwing skills developed in CE 201 and/or other existing throwing skills. Complex forms are studied including pouring vessels, lidded containers, plates, platters, and teapots, Techniques of creating handles, knobs, and other appendages will be studied. Students will develop skills necessary to make larger forms by stacking and joining thrown sections. Students will learn to establish relationships between functional objects in a set, and will explore the creative potential of altering and manipulating thrown forms. Exploration of surface decorating techniques and glaze solutions will be included. Stoneware will be used predominantly with an option for use of porcelain.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: CE 201.

CE 402 Ceramics IV: Major Studio

Students develop a mature body of work preparing for the Senior Thesis Exhibition. In addition, students are offered the necessary instruction and support needed to pursue in-depth explorations of ideas and processes of their choosing. Demonstrations, readings, discussions, and critical reviews continue studio work's conceptual, aesthetic, and technical development. Upon successfully completing the senior studio, students are ready to begin their professional careers.

Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: CE 401.

GRAPHIC DESIGN

Program Chair: Peter Alfano

GD 221 Branding and Visual Systems

This course is an exploration of visual identity and systems through historical, formal, and conceptual perspectives. Students will develop original logos, patterns, palettes, series, and typographic systems. They will practice working within constraints, designing applications at various scales and media, and codifying their design systems into comprehensive style guides.

Graphic Design Major requirement. Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: GD 211 or permission of instructor.

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

GD 302 Information Design

The goal of this studio course is to introduce students to basic principles of information design. Students will spend the semester exploring methods of collecting and categorizing data in order to reveal connections and create a better understanding of complex subjects. Assignments and presentations will explore traditional forms of data visualization – maps, diagrams, charts, timelines, interfaces and graphs – in both historical and contemporary contexts. Assignments will require both work in the field and within a studio environment.

Graphic Design Major requirement. 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: Major standing or permission of the instructor.

GD 331 Typography II

This course is an advanced investigation into conventional and unconventional forms of typography. A variety of projects provide exposure to complex issues of organization, hierarchy, and sequence in traditional and contemporary typographic communication. Special attention is given to refinement, detail, and finishing skills in all forms of typographic design while understanding the significance of context and audience, as well as the voice and narrative potential of type. Graphic Design Major requirement.

Graphic Design Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: GD 111 or GD 211 or permission of instructor.

GD 450 Degree Project

This course is devoted to independent, self-directed projects in graphic design, which are proposed, designed, written, and produced by each student on an individual basis. Faculty members serve as project advisors; this course is the studio component of the Senior Synthesis Seminar course; it also includes an "abridged synthesis writing" component for students choosing not to take a separate Senior Synthesis Seminar. Thesis projects involve visual research relating to a specific semester-long topic of visual communication. An appropriate form of presentation for the project in the Senior Thesis Exhibition and a separate written and visual summary culminate in book and/or website.

Graphic Design Major requirement. 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: Senior Major standing.

SEM 351 GD Interaction Design

Interaction Design is not new: books, print, and wayfinding sign systems are examples of interfaces that have been in place for centuries. Now, websites, tablets, phones, and mobile apps dominate the landscape, and the future might hold interfaces that are invisible or automatic or interactive only through voice. Our common definition of interface refers to the point at which two systems, subjects or organizations meet and interact. In design we focus on creating that point of interaction or point of delivery between a person and the interface. However, as technology shifts our attention from designing one-of-a-kind artifacts to the design of systems and experiences, this studio course will ask you to expand your notion of and approach to designing interfaces. This is a visual design course to emphasize cross-platform design experiences; Issues of hierarchy, color, size, readability, graphical user interface, architecture and the pragmatics of interface communication is explored while utilizing current technologies, such as HTML, CSS and JavaScript. Projects will look at the web as a dynamic visual environment.

Graphic Design Major requirement. 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Major requirement. Prerequisite: 6 GD credits or permission of the instructor.

ILLUSTRATION

Program Chair: Mary Anne Lloyd

IL 110 Methods and Media in Illustration

Students learn and build technical skills using a variety of water based materials such as acrylic, gouache, and watercolor as they apply to illustration. Students will gain an understanding of the effective use of color through painting and color mixing exercises. Focus on representational and observation.

Elective: Departmental Requirement for majors: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

IL 212 Illustration in Context

An illustration is generally commissioned to convey and promote a particular idea and/or product. This course is an introduction to illustration in a professional context, balancing an emphasis on concept and individual expression with continuous development of skills. Students will be exposed to different uses of illustration within the contexts of editorial, book, advertising, and product illustration. Class projects will emphasize the role of illustration in communication, the play between idea and text, with a highlight on process.

Departmental Requirement for majors: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: Any 100-level Illustration elective or permission of instructor.

IL 306 Introduction to Comics

This course is offered for students interested in using comics and sequential art as a means of communication and personal expression. Comics is a medium that is uniquely personal and combines the disciplines of writing and illustration to convey a narrative. Students will apply drawing and graphic design skills to develop signature styles in short and longer-term projects, while exploring possibilities of the medium by experimenting in storytelling, page layout, drawing styles and different media. There is an emphasis on self-publishing.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

IL 322 Illustration Majors Studio

This course introduces students to new visual problems, illustration formats, and image making solutions. Students will develop original concepts built on research and observation as well as conceptual ideation and invention. Those concepts and ideas will be resolved while refining manual drawing skills and exploring various techniques for creating finished illustrations. This course will be based around various relevant assignments that explore both the expressive and representational nature of illustration, accompanied by discussion of contemporary illustration practices.

Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: IL 321.

IL 336 Advanced Comics

Do you have an idea for a graphic novel or longform visual narrative?In this course, students will apply skills from Introduction to Comics to focus on one longer project throughout the semester, such as a 32-page comic or an equivalent excerpt of a graphic novel. Students will have the opportunity to brainstorm ideas, and advance their skills in research, scriptwriting, book design, and visual production. Alongside their semester-long projects, students will read and analyze content from well-known cartoonists, and develop storytelling skills that allow them to empathize and connect with readers on an emotional level. Students will be encouraged to take risks and experiment with narrative techniques, visual styles, media, and form. They will enhance their understanding of the medium through visits to exhibitions and public libraries, presentations with local artists, discussions with publishers, and through regular critiques with their professor and peers. By the end of the course, students can potentially self-publish their comic or pitch their graphic novel project to a publisher or literary agent.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: IL 306 or permission of instructor.

IL 340 Editorial Illustration: Concept to Print

This class provides a comprehensive, step-by-step guide to the modern editorial illustration process, designed to assist students transform the written word into compelling visual narratives while fostering a personal artistic voice. This structured creative process includes article analysis, ideation, revisions, production, and finalized illustrations. Personal point of view, visual metaphor, experimentation, and exploration of materials will be encouraged. Evaluation of the current editorial industry and editorial illustrators will be discussed and examined.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: This course is open to Juniors and Seniors. Second-year students may apply and will be admitted based on individual portfolio review.

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

IL 351 Introduction to the Discipline
This seminar course provides an overview of the history of illustration from the perspective of critical genres and movements in illustration. Students will participate in lectures, engage in readings, give presentations, and will work on projects individually and collaboratively. Students engage in a dialogue of the uses, definitions, and value of illustration as an enduring social art form.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: Major standing.

IL 423 Illustration Majors Studio
This course is devoted to an instructor-facilitated independent project (thesis). Students will create professional level illustrations and establish a body of work for portfolio presentation and for inclusion in the senior thesis BFA display. A written and supported component to the independent project is required.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: Major standing – IL 421.

METALSMITHING & JEWELRY

Program Chair: Sharon Portelance

MJ 101 Metalsmithing & Jewelry I
This one-semester introductory course blends technical instruction with an investigation of design and concept as it relates to ornament and function. Students develop confidence and proficiency with the basic skills of forming, soldering, and finishing. Classroom discussions and image presentations introduce the broad range of possibilities that the field of Metalsmithing and Jewelry encompasses that are part of this diverse and exciting field.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

MJ 250 Intermediate Metalsmithing I
An explorative learning course in intermediate experimentation into a wide range of small-scale sheet fabrication, plane manipulation, patterning, forming techniques, kinetic and mechanical applications, and the malleability of metal through forging and lost-wax casting. Copper, brass, nickel, aluminum, silver and gold become the primary problem solving materials for making as a site for bodily adornment, sculptural forms, utilitarian design, and mechanical components. Technical skills include general principles of metalworking (hammering physics: thinning, compression, tension), precision hand and calibration tools, acetylene soldering techniques, silicone/RTV/CNC mold making, small scale casting (metal and synthetics), metal lathe and general health/safety/material handling practices.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. MJ 250 Prerequisite: FN 109 (Metals) or MJ 101.

MJ 325 Advanced Metalsmithing I
An explorative learning course in advanced experimentation into a wide range of small-scale sheet fabrication, plane manipulation, patterning, forming techniques, kinetic and mechanical applications, and the malleability of metal through forging and lost-wax casting. Copper, brass, nickel, aluminum, silver and gold become the primary problem solving materials for making as a site for bodily adornment, sculptural forms, utilitarian design, and mechanical components. Technical skills include general principles of metalworking (hammering physics: thinning, compression, tension), precision hand and calibration tools, acetylene soldering techniques, silicone/RTV/CNC mold making, small scale casting (metal and synthetics), metal lathe and general health/safety/material handling practices.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. MJ 250 Prerequisite: MJ 250.

MJ 302 Metalsmithing & Jewelry Majors Studio
This one-year class introduces students to the full breadth of the studio practice of the Metalsmithing and Jewelry major. Students build on their previous skills while learning new technical skills. Students will develop a solid conceptual base for their work and

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

discover modes of working and interests that are specific to them through research, drawing and model making as well as finished pieces. Incorporated into the curriculum are projects that challenge students both conceptually and technically. In addition to assignments, self-designed explorations of technical, conceptual or design directions are included.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: MJ 301. An advanced tool kit is required.

MJ 402 Metalsmithing & Jewelry Majors Studio
The final year provides students with the opportunity to work in an independent manner. New technical skills may be introduced, yet emphasis is placed on honing already acquired skills. Each student is expected to select, research, and articulate a direction that culminates into a related body of work and written thesis.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: MJ 401.

PAINTING

Program Chair: Honour Mack

PT 221 Independent Projects in Painting
This course is designed to help students learn to create structured parameters for independent work. Students working in any discipline will develop and investigate their ideas through the lens of painting. Students/instructor discussions will establish self directed projects throughout the semester. Emphasis will be placed on form as it relates to content, research and process. Specific materials will be determined by the nature of the independent project.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisites: PT100 and any 2D studio elective (100-level sculpture or print elective may substitute PT100 with instructor permission). Required to major in Painting.

PT 223 Paintings without Pictures
This course is a great cross-disciplinary experience: 2D, 3D and 4D artists benefit from exploring an alternative visual vocabulary. It pushes away from external references and allows artists to explore a variety of ways to express themselves. This can include emotional expression, decorative embellishment, complex metaphors, spiritual connections, material explorations, and philosophical inquiry. This class examines the persistence of the visual art object, with particular emphasis on abstract painting.

Abstraction offers exciting opportunities for artists. A series of exercises will provide the opportunity to experiment with traditions of abstract imagery, materials, and processes in an effort to help them develop a vocabulary of their own. A series of visual presentations will accompany assignments, and periodic field trips will support the content of the class work. This course will also continue to build on the formal skills gathered from Foundation Painting, including color development, drawing and compositional skills, and verbal analysis of form.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

PT 225 Water Media
This course examines the relationship of specific water-based painting media and techniques to the content and activity of painting. The sequencing and techniques of water-based media are often opposite and / or drastically different than those of oil painting. Significant developments in the acrylic paint industry facilitate completely different potential for creative painterly expression (new mediums, grounds, techniques, and paints). Students will explore and combine a variety of water media with the expectation of discovering a new, personal approach to creating images and developing visual ideas. Students are initially taught the specific properties and use of watercolor, gouache, and acrylic and then work to combine these media with pastel, watercolor pencil, watercolor crayons, and tempera. Demonstrations, lectures, and art historical references will impart a basic understanding of methods and materials. Emphasis will be placed on facility with material, understanding of formal issues, color use, and quality and range of investigations.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

PT 322 Painting Majors Studio

Students develop productive studio habits, explore personal themes and begin to define their own visual language. They are encouraged to investigate a variety of materials and processes. Trips to artist studios, major museums and galleries supplement the educational experience. Critiques, which include discussions, lectures and demonstrations, and a variety of visiting artists are held regularly.

Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisites: Major standing and PT 321.

PT 351 Introduction to the Discipline

This course looks at a range of painting strategies and investigates painting through its histories, as a technical skill, and as an intellectual and philosophical project.Intro to the Discipline is complementary to Junior Studio. Readings, presentations, videos and discussions will establish a foundation of critical ideas, vocabulary, models, and approaches pertinent to the serious study of painting. Topics include the development of content by looking at genre, process, materials and formats; a broad range of histories; painting in the expanded field; and the curation of exhibitions. This Studio Seminar course provides the ground for you to more clearly define your own practice and relationship to the various histories and contexts through which your work gains meaning, particularly those contexts that have defined contemporary painting. This is a mandatory course for all Painting Majors.

Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: Major standing.

PT 422 Painting Majors Studio

This course provides an uninterrupted opportunity for the advanced painter to develop independently. Instructors critique, lecture, give demonstrations, and participate with students in both one-on-one situations and group discussions. Emphasis is placed on developing a personal painting process, while building and sustaining an extended body of work. The course also addresses the realities of being a working artist in contemporary culture (i.e. gallery representation, grants & funding, job information, etc.). Visiting artists, trips to museums and galleries, readings and lectures help to facilitate these goals.

Major requirement: 3 credits/semester, 6-credit possibility with permission of the Chair; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: PT 421.

PHOTOGRAPHY

Program Chair: Justin Kirchoff

PH 222 Color Photography

Color Photography introduces students to the concepts of the digital darkroom. Time will be spent studying the canon of color photography, and the artists using color materials as a primary means of expression. The primary goal of the class is to create a portfolio of exhibition quality inkjet prints. Skill sets covered but not limited to: scanning of color films, use of digital cameras, image manipulation software, color management and calibration tools.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: FN 101 or permission of instructor.

PH 232 Large Format Photography

Working with a view camera, students explore the unique aesthetic possibilities of the large negative. The zone system of exposure control, fine printing techniques, chemical formulation, archival processing and methods of presentation are also covered.

Elective: 3 credits/semester: 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: PH 206 Medium Format Photography or permission of instructor.

PH 314 Experimental Photography

This course will explore the malleable and plural ways artists engage with the photographic medium. The assignments and coursework will encourage students to incorporate an interdisciplinary approach to the medium. We will cover present and past artists who have used photography as an extension of their studio practice and have had an experimental approach to the medium. Students will be expected to think outside the box and utilize new methods for creating photographic work. Lectures, group

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

discussions, and assignments will cover photography, silkscreen, collages, artist books, and sculptural considerations.
Elective: 3 credits. Prerequisite: PH 101 or PH 105 or permission of the instructor.

PH 322 Photography Majors Studio
This critique class, supplemented with appropriate readings and slide presentations, is designed to allow each junior to explore the forms and content of their own work.
Major standing: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: PH 321.

PH 422 Photography Majors Studio
This advanced project allows each student to work independently, with bi-weekly group and individual critiques, to produce a body of work that can then be refined into a final presentation form--portfolio, exhibition, book, installation, etc.--for the Senior Thesis Exhibition. Editing, sequencing, and presentation methods are covered in detail.
Major standing: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: PH 421.

PRINTMAKING

Program Chair: Bennett Morris

PR 101 Printmaking 1: Relief
Students gain a working understanding of the tools, materials, and processes of relief printmaking. Through intensive exploration of several techniques, including linocut, woodcut, and multi color printing, students develop and refine personal images. Students will gain familiarity with safe and professional printmaking practices and develop a language for printmaking critique. This is a great studio class to explore your existing ideas related to drawing, painting, design and illustration.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

PR 240 The Book as Visual Object
This rigorous, in-depth examination of the book as an art form will introduce students to traditional bookbinding materials, structures and techniques. Regular assignments or "prompts" will present an opportunity to apply and translate those structures incorporating them into one's own studio practice. Emphasis will be on encouraging participants to tailor what is presented in class to suit their own needs and aesthetic and to explore the endless possibilities of the book. The semester will be comprised of weekly hands-on demonstrations, guided studio time, critiques and periodic field trips.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite. Not open to first year students.

PR 302 Printmaking Majors Studio
This course emphasizes the development and enhancement of each student's studio practice and the production of a range of work in a range of media. The primary focus is on your work, looking specifically at how you articulate your ideas, the quality and quantity of your work and your contextualization of what you make. The course structure provides a framework on which students can build an increasingly personalized studio exploration. Assignments leave plenty of room for the assertion of self and guide students through generative and iterative processes designed to encourage experimentation, risk taking, and the deployment of already established passions as well as movement into unknown territories. Student work is refined through a rigorous critique process and individual studio meetings with faculty. Moving through a range of projects, students build skills and acquire the knowledge to critically position their work within the larger historical and conceptual framework that defines the increasingly broad field of print. Studio assignments, technical demonstrations, readings, research presentations, critique, field trips, workshops and special projects all present students with new ideas and ways of making studio work and crafting a sustainable practice, while also helping students increase their communication and critical thinking skills.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: PR 301.

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

PR 402 Printmaking Majors Studio
This course emphasizes the development and enhancement of your studio practice and the production of a cohesive body of work. The primary focus is on your work, looking specifically at how you articulate your ideas, the quality and quantity of your work and your contextualization of what you make. Seniors work in a self-directed manner in terms of media and content, with deadlines for in progress and final critiques propelling the student toward the completion of a fully realized Thesis. Student work is refined through a rigorous critique process and individual studio meetings with faculty. Students will critically position their work within the larger historical and conceptual framework that defines the increasingly broad field of print. Studio projects, technical demonstrations, readings, research presentations, critique, field trips, workshops and special projects offer students further ideas and ways of making studio work and crafting a sustainable practice, while also helping students increase their communication and critical thinking skills.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: PR 401.

SCULPTURE

Program Chair: Joshua Reiman

SC 105 The Sculptural Imagination: Wood, Steel and Foundry Practices
This course is an introduction to the basic techniques involved in woodworking, foundry processes, and welded steel sculpture. We will investigate materials, methods, and concepts that serve as the foundation for creating sculptural forms. Through weekly assignments, lectures, demonstrations, and discussions we will explore traditional and experimental approaches to the theory and practice involved in making sculpture. In each of the assignments we will study the historical, cultural, and contemporary applications and implications of these given sculptural techniques, however, the subject matter for all assignments is open to your individual interpretation. Students will learn how to identify materials, proper material usage, learn tools and safety within the Sculpture area, and learn articulation of these materials (both physically and audibly) via critiques of finished works. The primary objective for this course is to develop the skills needed to interpret and articulate contemporary modes of creating a sculpture that students will encounter as professional artists and creative problem solvers.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

SC 229 Club as Context: Collage, Sound, and Space
Building off of concepts and exercises explored in Space and Temporality, this course situates DJing and the nightclub as a form of social sculpture, installation, sound collage that invites embodiment. Students will engage with the historical and cultural roots of DJ culture while developing technical and creative skills in DJing and sound editing seen through a sculptural lens. By drawing connections between sculpture and sound, students will create projects that range from Audio Collages, installations, movement exercises and group planning that consider how music and space interact, transforming environments and shaping social experiences. An emphasis on figurative sculpture, installation, sound and movement will are be present in this course.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

SC 322 Sculpture: Junior Majors Studio
This course emphasizes the making of sculpture: inspiration, identifying material resources, developing technical skills, craftsmanship and critical awareness of visual and structural integrity. Students will complete three works and supporting materials in the form of three-dimensional studies, experiments and drawings are expected. Students choose materials and subjective references, and works may incorporate resources and inspiration from many other disciplines. Students develop productive work habits and learn to take charge of their direction and keep to a schedule. Technical assistance is available to help with new processes. Students work in all three studios of the department.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: SC 321.

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

SC 422 Sculpture: Senior Majors Studio
This course equips students with the wherewithal to sustain artistic growth and emphasizes an independent and significant investigation of personal artistic interests and sensibilities. Students determine the nature of the work they produce, choosing technical means, materials, scale and context. Sculpture is approached as the perceptual and philosophical exploration of form and our interactions with it. Visual organization and craftsmanship, essential to making clear content, are stressed. Two complete works and supporting material in the form of three dimensional studies or experiments and drawings are expected, culminating in the presentation of a written thesis. Students work in all studios of the department.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: SC 421. 6 credit option for Seniors only.

TEXTILE & FASHION DESIGN

Program Chair: Alysha Kupferer

TF 203 (S) Surface Design
Surface design focuses on the creation of color and pattern on textile surfaces through dyeing, embroidery, and surface manipulation. Students create technical samples and also critically explore the role of textile surfaces in sustainability including learning to apply surface design techniques to alter and redesign post-consumer materials into new textiles through mending, stitching, and dyeing. Through the creation of a color swatch library, students develop a technical understanding of natural dyes, dye chemistry, and the inherent strengths and weaknesses of working with various dye materials: synthetic dyes, fresh plant matter, raw dried materials, dried ground materials, and natural extracts. With an understanding of dye chemistry in place, students will further alter textile surfaces through the application of pattern through mending, piecing, embroidery, and surface manipulation.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

TF 215 Weaving
Students gain a comprehensive understanding of weaving using floor looms while exploring compositional strategies of woven textile design. The course emphasizes the expressive potential of color, texture, fiber, pattern, yarn, and surface in combination with woven structures. Students study yarn handling, loom mechanics, color and weave combination, and categories of woven structures while creating an index of woven samples and a series of fully finished woven projects.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

TF 221 Draping & Construction
By draping directly on the dressform, students develop sloper patterns for foundation garment shapes. Slopers are then modified through pattern development to create basic styles. Students study correct draping technique, basic pattern drafting skills, and professional pattern marking and annotation. Throughout the course, students study garment construction, finishing techniques, and fit assessment through creating both sample garments and finished garments. Projects provide opportunities to apply draping and drafting skills to develop unique garments that investigate the expressive potential of silhouette, color, texture and materials to convey concepts.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: TF 102.

TF 325 Collection Development
Focusing on creative development and technical growth, students develop a body of work that is conceptually cohesive and learn to apply technical skill and craftsmanship to professional output. Students practice how to sketch, refine, and develop collections of work and how to apply research concepts to studio output. Throughout the semester, students develop a body of work from concept to finished work through a process of creating technical samples, sourcing materials, developing designs, assessing design success, and constructing finished pieces. This course emphasizes the development of professional skills, personal organization, and

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

time management related to complex projects. Students practice professional presentation techniques at the end of the semester by exhibiting their finished body of work either in an exhibition or as part of the Fashion Show and developing a portfolio of documentation.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: TF 322 or TF 323.

TF 422 Majors Thesis Studio
Seniors investigate areas of specific interest in textiles or fashion in order to realize a senior thesis based on a comprehensively researched personal concept that synthesizes references in order to develop new knowledge. Students work through processes of ideation, sourcing, prototyping, and finishing their chosen body of work. Emphasis is placed on professional practices, time management, and the development of a sustainable studio practice while executing thesis work. Learning takes place through group discussions, shared critiques, and studio visits.
Major requirement: 6 credits/semester; 12 hours/week. Prerequisite: TF 421.

WOODWORKING & FURNITURE DESIGN

Program Chair: Matt Hutton

WF 101 Introduction to Woodworking
This is a beginning level introduction to wood as a visual and building material. Assignments and exercises focus on the application of various techniques such as carving and fabrication to create dynamic forms that explore function & composition. The use of power and hand tools will be applied to create a variety of objects that illustrate an in-depth understanding of working with wood. Students will first design and create custom croquet mallets, utilizing largely reductive methods, which will be used in an outdoor croquet match. A small Shaker style end table will be made as an instructional exercise leading into a final custom occasional table design and build.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisites.

WF 125 Models & Mockups
Working with wood is often expensive, time consuming and requires a great deal of planning. This course will explore that crucial planning process as we focus on model making, scaled samples and full-size mockups. Through the use of appropriate techniques and tools from nail guns to the laser cutter, we will build sets, models and examples of larger work proposals. Assignments will be individually tailored to fit your studio work interests and cover topics related to achieving your own goals within your studio practice, such as bringing your digital environmental work into the real world.
Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. No prerequisite.

WF 322 Wood & Furniture Major Studio
The completion of Junior Studio is dedicated toward learning intermediate to advanced techniques as well as the development of a strong understanding of wood as a building material. Individual projects will allow for exploration in concept, utility and technique. The primary mode of making will be in the Krenovian Standing Cabinet.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: WF 321.

WF 422 Wood & Furniture Major Studio
Students are given quick warm-up assignments throughout the year while concurrently developing their work in close communication with faculty. This course is predominantly dedicated toward the development of the students' body of work that will accompany their written thesis.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: WF 421.

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

SEMINARS

SEM 452 Senior Synthesis
This course is taken in the final semester of the senior year. It is an integral course with the studio practice. Students will be led through a guided research and writing process to identify and explore what their inspirations are for their studio work, how those interests are played out historically and what their relevance is to contemporary art and culture. The class will culminate in a fully articulated written thesis that explains and details their thesis work. Students will present their ideas at various points throughout the semester and conversations will be held about the ideas underlying their work both in the classroom and in individualized studio visits.
Major requirement: 3 credits/semester; 3 hours/week. Prerequisite: Senior Standing.

MINORS – STUDIO

DRAWING MINOR Drawing Minor Coordinator: Sarah Shaw
The Drawing Minor is made up of 18 credits, and is recommended for students who are genuinely interested in drawing as a creative process, and will likely enroll in drawing classes consistently throughout their college career. The final 3 credits of the Drawing Minor (Capstone experience) is designed to help students understand how drawing plays a fundamental role in their personal studio practice. The drawing minor is made up of 18 credits: DR 100 along with 12 cr. of drawing electives, followed by DR 400 / Independent study in Drawing (Capstone class). Connecting with the Coordinator is recommended.

DR 400 Advanced Drawing
This course concentrates on creating a structured environment in which students can begin to build independent working processes and linear bodies of work. It is designed to complement the experience in the major studio, despite the student's chosen area of concentration. Emphasis is placed on developing content driven work and research skills, while continuing to focus on the formal aspects of a drawing experience. Course serves as the capstone experience for the Drawing Minor.
Elective: 3 credits/semester, 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: Completion of 15 credits DR Minor requirements.

(M) MUSIC MINOR Music Minor Coordinator: Steve Drown
The music minor consists of 18 credits: AM 100, AM 110 and AM 400 are required along with 9 cr. of music electives. Any MECA student with a cumulative GPA of 2.5 or higher in good academic standing can enroll in the Music Minor. To apply, each student must fill out the Music Minor Application Form and meet with Steve Drown, the coordinator of the Bob Crewe Program in Art and Music. Courses that are required for this minor are designated with (M).

AM 400 (M) Music Minor Capstone
This course is a culminating experience for seniors in the minor. Students will build upon the skills and concepts introduced in the Music Minor to realize a project of substantial effort within a semester. Examples include: scoring a film/animation, producing a live performance, recording a 6-Song EP of original work, creating an installation that incorporates sound, or writing a 10-song collection. A statement of purpose and a project plan is required. Students work with a faculty advisor under an independent study arrangement. The faculty advisor and student meet prior, during and at the completion of the capstone project. Through this project, students will demonstrate their skills and understanding of how music and sound both affects and supports their art or how they have further developed within the field of sound/music. The concept and scope of the project must be approved by the Coordinator of the Bob Crewe Program in Art and Music.
Elective: 3 credits/semester, 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: Senior standing.

STUDIO & SEMINAR COURSES *[continued]*

(AE) ART AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP MINOR A&E Minor Coordinator: Adriane Herman

The Art and Entrepreneurship (AE) Minor at Maine College of Art gives students the opportunity to pursue an entrepreneurial focus across studio disciplines. Art and Entrepreneurship courses introduce students to the core concepts of launching a business and applying innovative strategies to a wide range of artistic endeavors including sourcing, identifying resources, opportunity shaping, and building a team. Through project-based courses, client projects, internships, workshops and community partnerships, students develop a range of skills and knowledge to launch and successfully grow their entrepreneurial endeavors. Courses that can be used in this minor are designated with (AE). 15 credits required.

ST 400 (AE) Art & Entrepreneurship Minor Capstone

This course is a culminating experience for seniors in the Art & Entrepreneurship minor. Students will work with the minor coordinator to develop the concept and scope of the capstone project.

Elective: 3 credits/semester, 6 hours/week. Prerequisite: Senior standing.

(PE) PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT MINOR PE Minor Coordinator: Adriane Herman

The public engagement minor is made up of 18 credits: (PE) FYL 100, (PE) Studio elective, (PE) Liberal Arts elective, (PE) SEM 330, (PE) Internship with a community partner and (PE) PE 400 Public Engagement Capstone. Any MECA student who has successfully completed a minimum of 30 credits and has achieved a 2.5 GPA or higher may apply to this program. See minor coordinator for application. Courses that can be used in this minor are designated with (PE).

PE 400 (PE) Public Engagement Capstone

The Public Engagement Capstone with community-engaged component is a culminating experience for seniors in the minor. Students are encouraged to work independently, working with their chosen community partner prior to the capstone to develop a proposal. The faculty advisor, community partner and student meet prior, during and after the capstone project. The capstone is project based with a text component. Requirements of the text are determined with the faculty advisor in relationship to the work. Requirements for the capstone include a corollary statement of purpose, project plan, and studio component. Additionally, each capstone is shared publicly and includes documentation that is permanently stored in the PE archive and MECA&D library. Students work with a faculty advisor under an independent study arrangement. Students can complete the Capstone requirement any time after their junior year, including summer.

Elective: 3 credits/semester; 6 hours/week. Prerequisites: Senior standing.